

FOUR-COURSE SYSTEM

COURSE 3 - DATA ENGINEERING 2026

C3-116 Completion & Maintenance Plan

Course closure, version refresh, evidence maintenance and experience-led growth

Status	RC1 - FINAL-LAYER QA PASS CANDIDATE
Course boundary	C3-104 = C3-09 phase Gate only; C3-113 = separate course-wide graduation Gate
Release boundary	Course 3 is NOT FINAL until Mentor/PWA + whole-course release regression are complete.

Permanent engineering behavior controls the course. Vendor UI/version notes are refreshable references, and external links are support-only; the course artifacts remain sufficient without them.

1. Course completion checklist

- All 140 core lessons complete under attempt → review → changed retry → explain → evidence/mastery rules.
- All 10 Mini-Labs and at least one protected phase Gate per phase are PASS; failed attempts remain in history.
- RetailPulse satisfies C3-110 and C3-111.
- C3-113 independently PASS: all eight competencies PASS, all required events/evidence complete, fresh variant, zero unresolved critical failure.
- Portfolio evidence is sanitized, reproducible and mapped to claims.
- C3-114 transition plan is active. C3-115 DP-700 remains optional.

2. Refresh cadence

Fabric / OneLake / DP-700	Before hands-on after a long gap, before certification prep, and after major platform/security changes.
Airflow / Spark / Kafka / Delta / dbt	Before reusing the lab/project after a long gap or dependency/runtime compatibility change.
Python / testing / dependencies	Per active project supported-version and security needs.
Course links / vendor docs	Quarterly or when a learner reports a broken/outdated source.
Portfolio screenshots	Only when materially useful; do not churn evidence for cosmetic UI changes.

3. Current 11 Sep 2026 reference snapshot

Python	3.14 maintenance lane used by general C3 environment; phase-specific compatibility exceptions remain explicit.
dbt Core	1.12.4 is current stable 1.x; C3-02 intentionally uses dbt-duckdb 1.11 compatibility lane.
Airflow	3.3.1 supported/current course lane.
Spark	4.2.0 current course lane.
Kafka	4.3.1 supported release.
Delta Lake	4.4.0; Delta-Spark defaults to Spark 4.2.
DP-700	Skills measured as of 21 Jul 2026.

4. Evidence maintenance

- Keep one polished capstone release reproducible; do not overwrite historical evidence simply to look newer.
- Record dependency/platform versions used for successful runs.
- Archive obsolete evidence and explain what changed.
- Keep secrets/private data outside repositories and screenshots.

5. Experience-led growth loop

WORK → NOTICE A REAL GAP → STUDY THAT GAP → APPLY → DOCUMENT → REVIEW. Do not restart the whole course for every new tool version. Reopen only the relevant phase when real work exposes a durable gap.

6. When a new core lesson is justified

Add a core lesson only when a durable engineering competency is genuinely missing. UI changes, certification wording, minor command changes and vendor feature renames belong in the refresh/source register rather than expanding the 140-lesson core indefinitely.

7. Current reference links

[dbt-core 1.12.4](#)

[Airflow supported versions](#)

[Apache Spark current documentation](#)

[Apache Kafka supported downloads](#)

[Delta Lake 4.4.0 release context](#)